



Gamma RP

1st Edition

A simple roleplaying system meant to be dynamic and expandible

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November 30, 2025



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Introduction

Gamma RP, or GRP, is a tabletop role-playing game (TTRPG) system meant to strike a balance between pure theater-of-the-mind systems and map based tabletop systems.

I've found that the most engaging TTRPG systems for me were ones that had a visual element, but these by necessity often put a lot of burden of preparation on the moderator(s) of the game. They also can indirectly limit the amount of improvisation possible by the players since the moderator needs to prepare visual assets based on what the players choose, and this slows down the game.

It also takes time away from worldbuilding.

For me, the motivation for being the moderator (or game master, dungeon master, etc.) of a TTRPG is to build a world that my players can explore, interact with, and build characters and parts of the world themselves. I needed a system where any maps, items, or enemies could be very quickly created from scratch on-the-fly by an untrained game master.

So, faced with my perpetual lack of free time, I spent a few years creating GRP and the Gamma Nebula Setting.

The Gamma RP system and the Gamma Nebula Setting are separated into different sections of this rulebook. The base system of rules is meant to be easy to build on top of, but the Gamma Nebula Setting is the setting that I initially built it for. Given how much work I've put into both, I am of the mind to release them together.

I need to make this introduction more sensible and legible, but for now this placeholder will suffice!

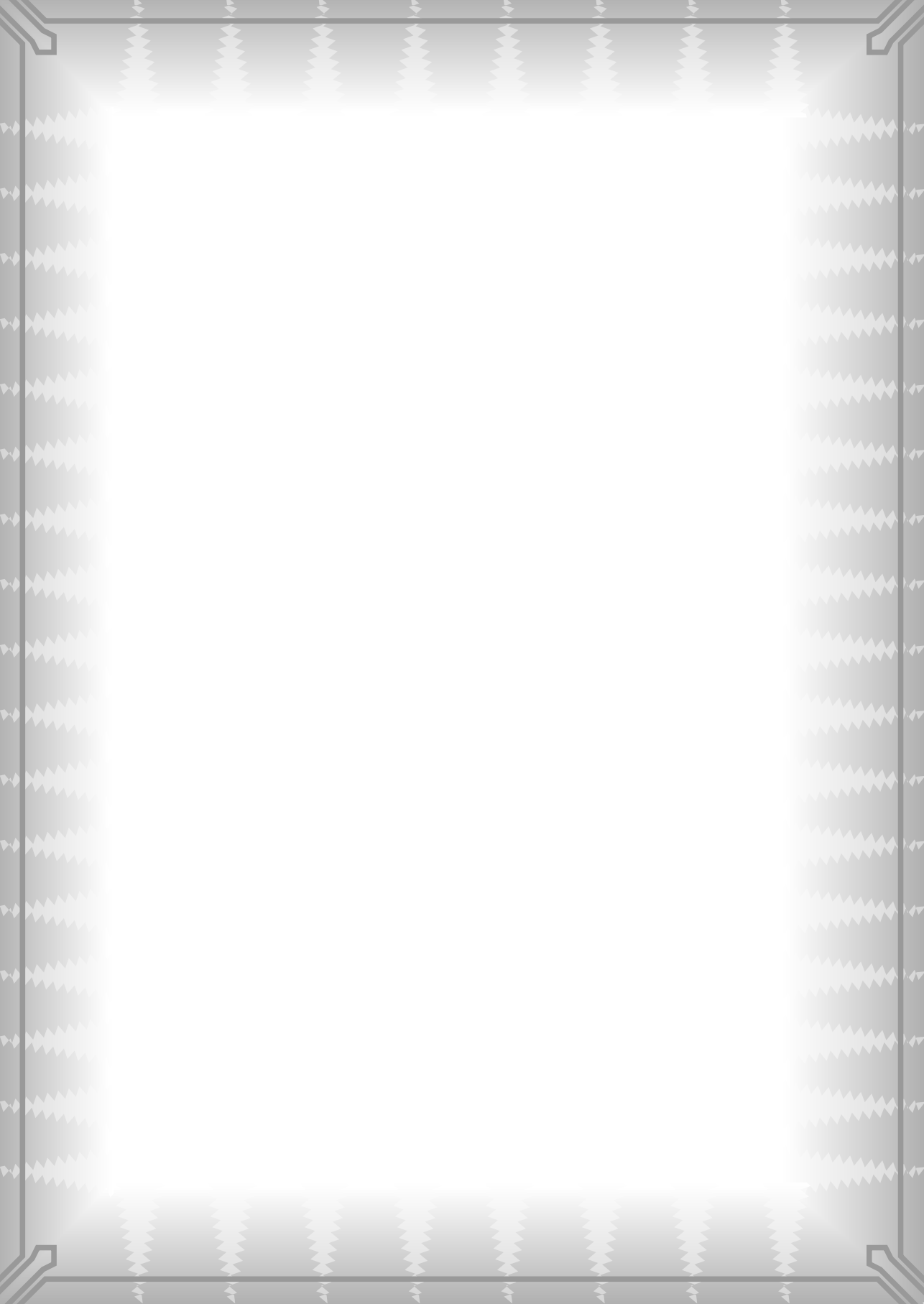
Enjoy!

Here is a purely tikz generated logo attempt:

Gamma RP, or  is so cool that I use it to preserve food in my refrigerator

Part I

The System



2 The Basics

TRP is a tabletop role-playing game. This is a specific class of improvisational acting game in which the participants are divided into *Game Masters* (often referred to as GM's) and *Players*. Most games will require at least one game master in order to play the game, and the game master and players work together to tell a story.

The Game Master is responsible for constructing the world around the Players, and giving the players a setting to interact with. The Players are responsible for maintaining a Player Character- a character who interacts with and influences the setting defined by the Game Master.

Since the game is collaborative in this way, it is more fun and fair if the Game Master does not know the outcome of all actions in the setting. In order to fairly decide events where the outcome is unsure- TRP uses the roll of a set of dice to decide whether a course of action is successful.

2.1 The Fundamental Dice Mechanic

The fundamental dice mechanic in TRP is based on 12 sided dice. If you intend to play the game on a real physical tabletop, you may want to obtain a few dozen 12 sided dice.

Typically, the notation for a roll is written as $DXaY$

X is the number of dice you roll.

Y is the *advantage* on the roll, which indicates how many sides of a dice count as a success.

If any of the dice you roll pass the success threshold, then your roll is a success.

This means that both larger X and larger Y indicate a higher probability of success.

Higher Y mean the roll is successful even at lower thresholds. An advantage of 1 is the default when advantage is not specified. This means that is only successful on a 12. However an advantage of 2 means the roll is successful on any instance of a 12 or an 11 (there are two numbers now on which the roll is successful).

Let's look at a few example rolls.

①, ⑫, ③, ⑫
④, ⑤, ⑫, ⑦, ⑧, ⑨, ⑩, ⑪, ③, ①, ⑫
④, ⑤, ⑫, ⑦, ⑧, ⑨, ⑩, ⑪, ③, ①, ⑫
④, ⑤, ⑫, ⑦, ⑧, ⑨, ⑩, ⑪, ③, ①, ⑫
④, ⑤, ⑫, ⑦, ⑧, ⑨, ⑩, ⑪, ③, ①, ⑫

In general an advantage of Y means the top Y numbers on the dice will count as a success. An advantage of 0 is the exception, which still is successful if any dice rolls a 12.

An advantage of 12 means that the roll automatically succeeds.

Advantage can also be negative. For convenience this is written as *disadvantage* which is the negative of the advantage. A roll of $DXa(-Z)$ is written equivalently as $DX\textcolor{red}{d}Z$.

A roll with at *disadvantage* of Z means that Z dice within the roll need to land on 12 for the roll to be successful. For example, with a roll of $D4\textcolor{red}{d}2$, 2 of the 4 dice need to land on 12 in order for the roll to be successful.

Note that the rolls $DXa1$, $DXa0$, $DX\textcolor{red}{d}1$ are all identical, requiring a single dice of the set to result 12 in order to result a success.

When the disadvantage is greater than the number of dice being rolled, the roll is an automatic failure, since there is no way to obtain a number of successful rolls higher than the number of dice being rolled.

With more than 2 disadvantage on any roll,

the probability of a successful roll rapidly diminishes. A disadvantage of 12 or greater is considered an automatic failure for the roll (even though there is theoretically a chance of 12 twelve-sided dice all rolling 12). This is meant to simply be symmetric with the advantage mechanic where an advantage of 12 guarantees success.

In general, when a character has more than 2 disadvantage on a roll they will not succeed unless they use a dice modifying ability.

Then you pad the whole chapter with lorem ipsum text

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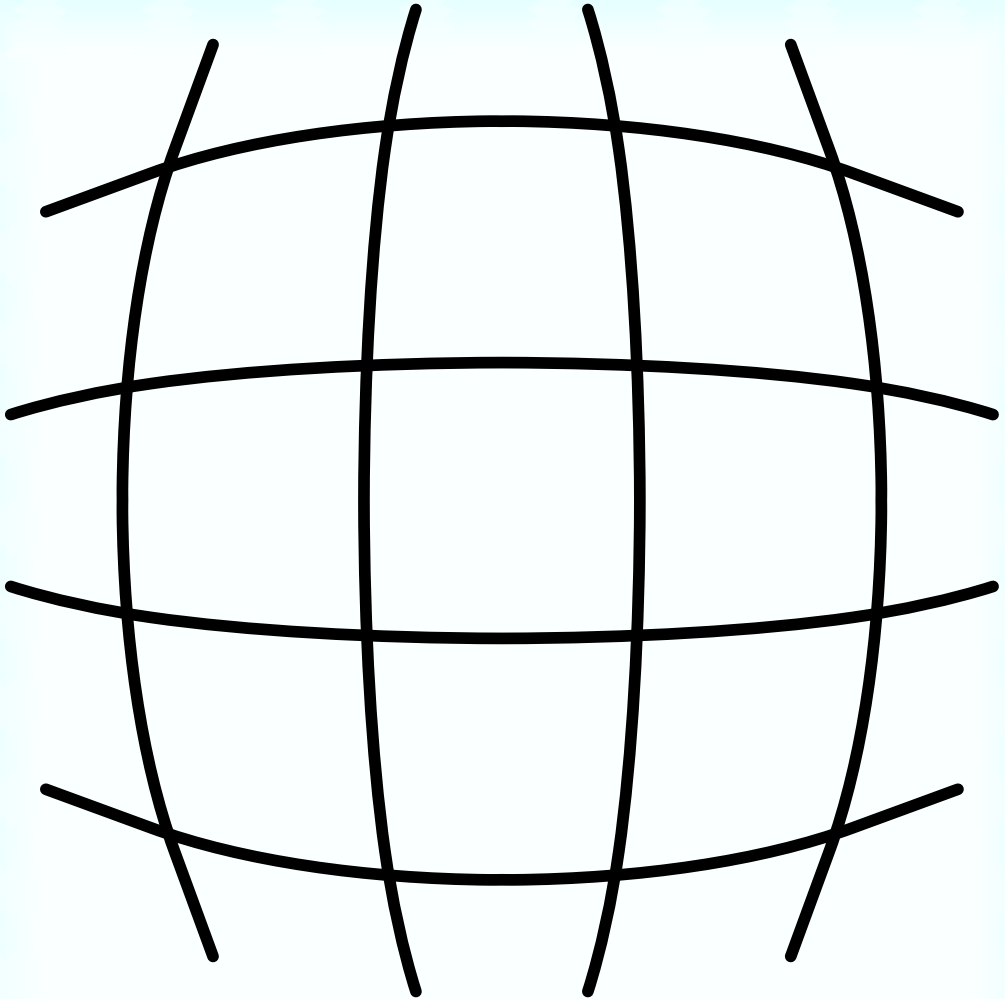


Figure 2.1-a: Test of the GRPfigure environment

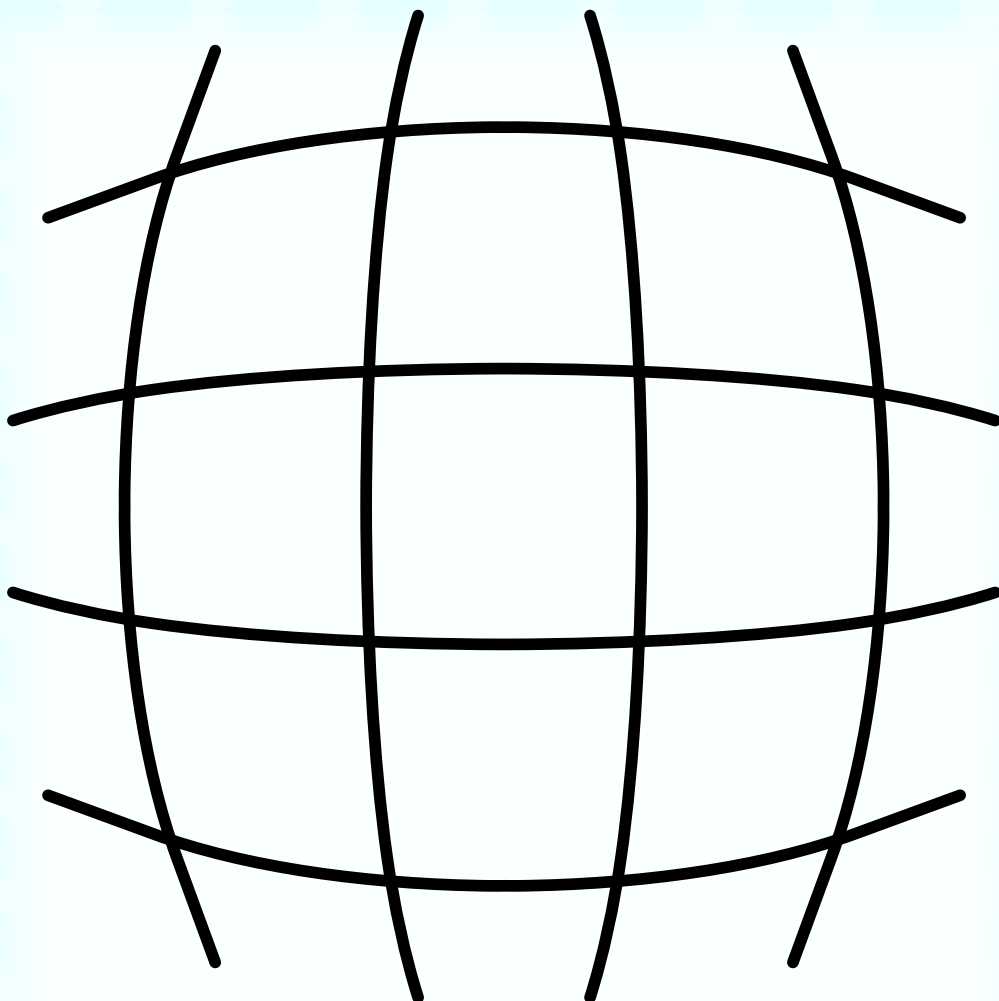
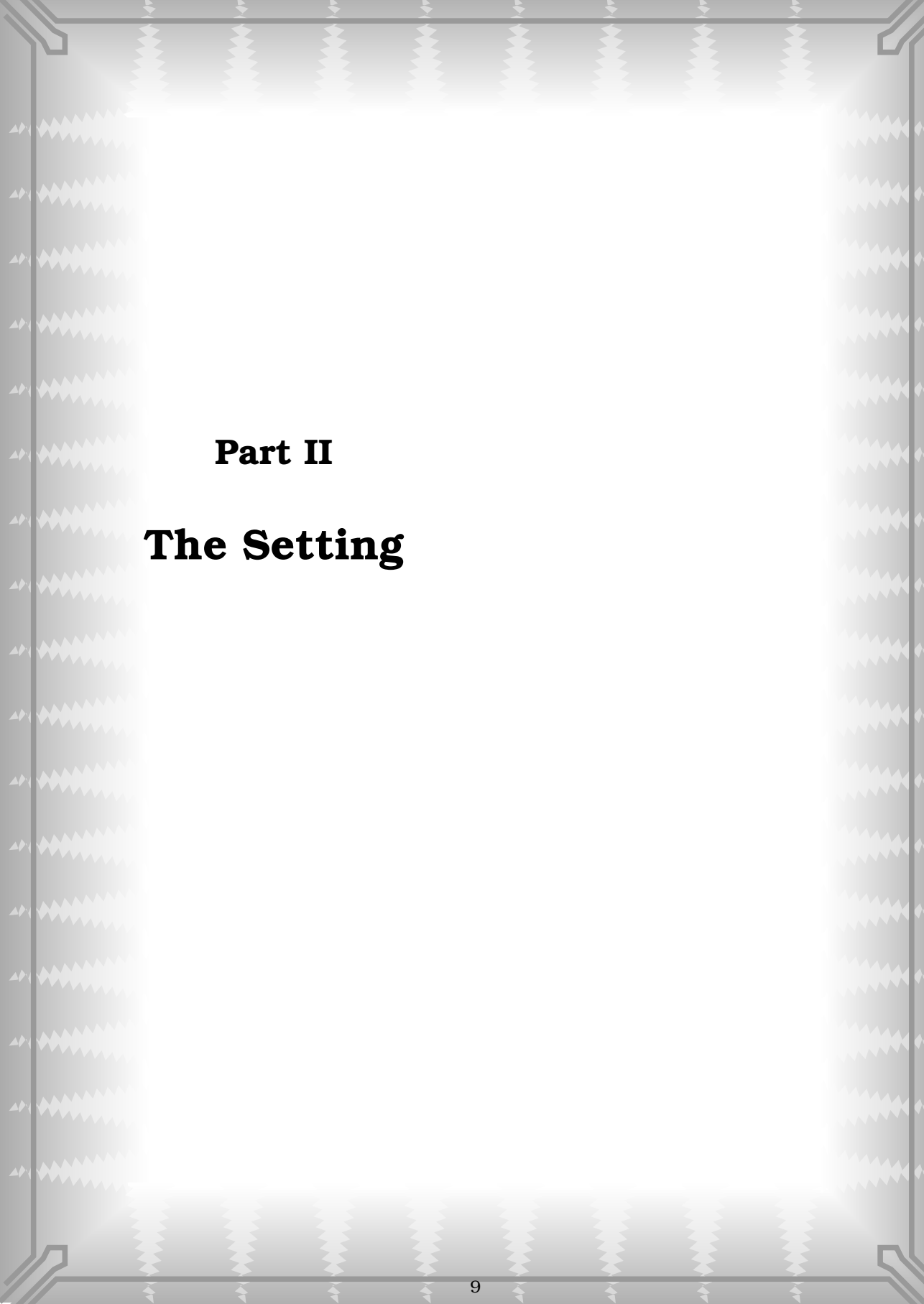


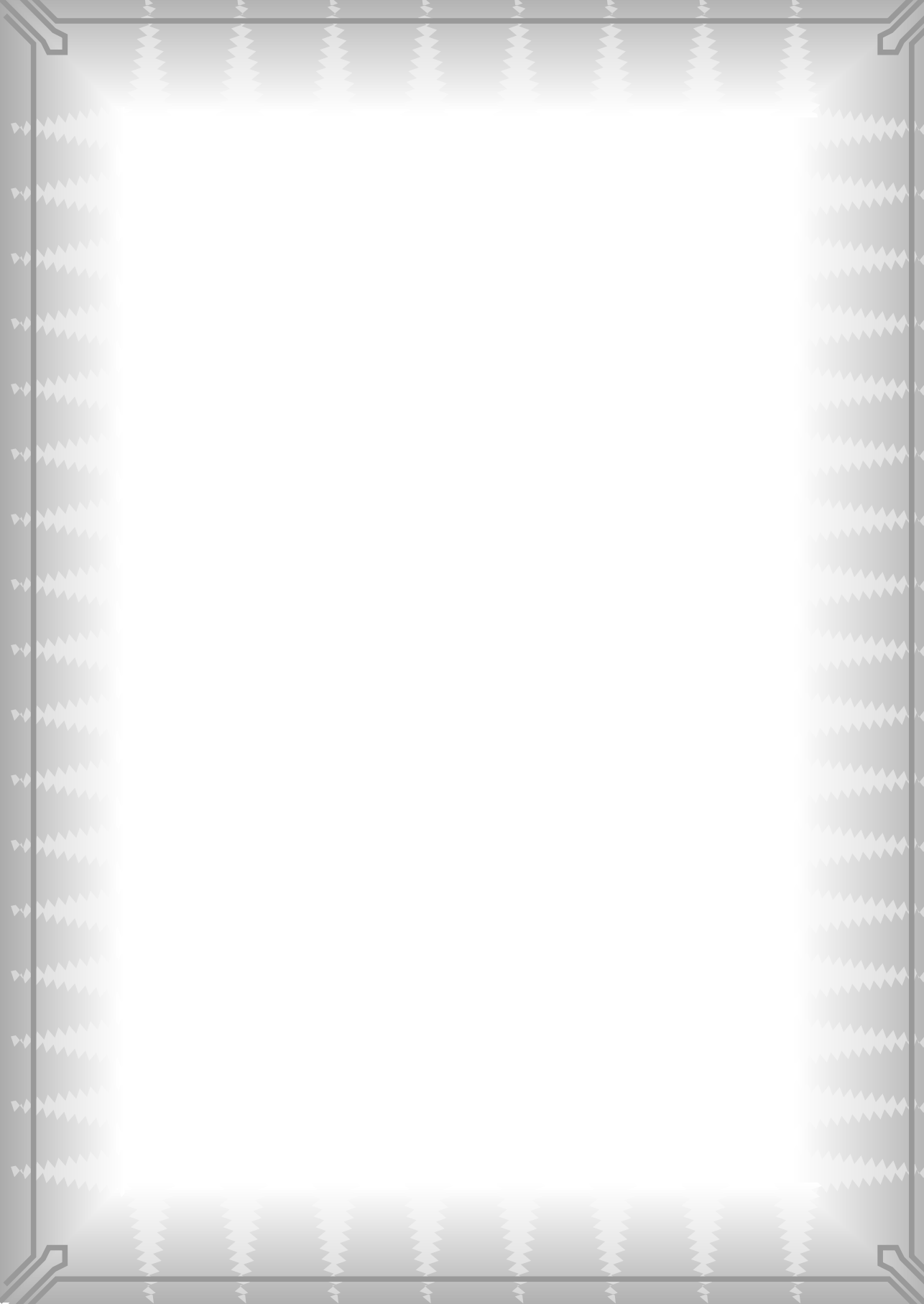
Figure 2.1-b: Another test of the GRPfigure environment

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Part II

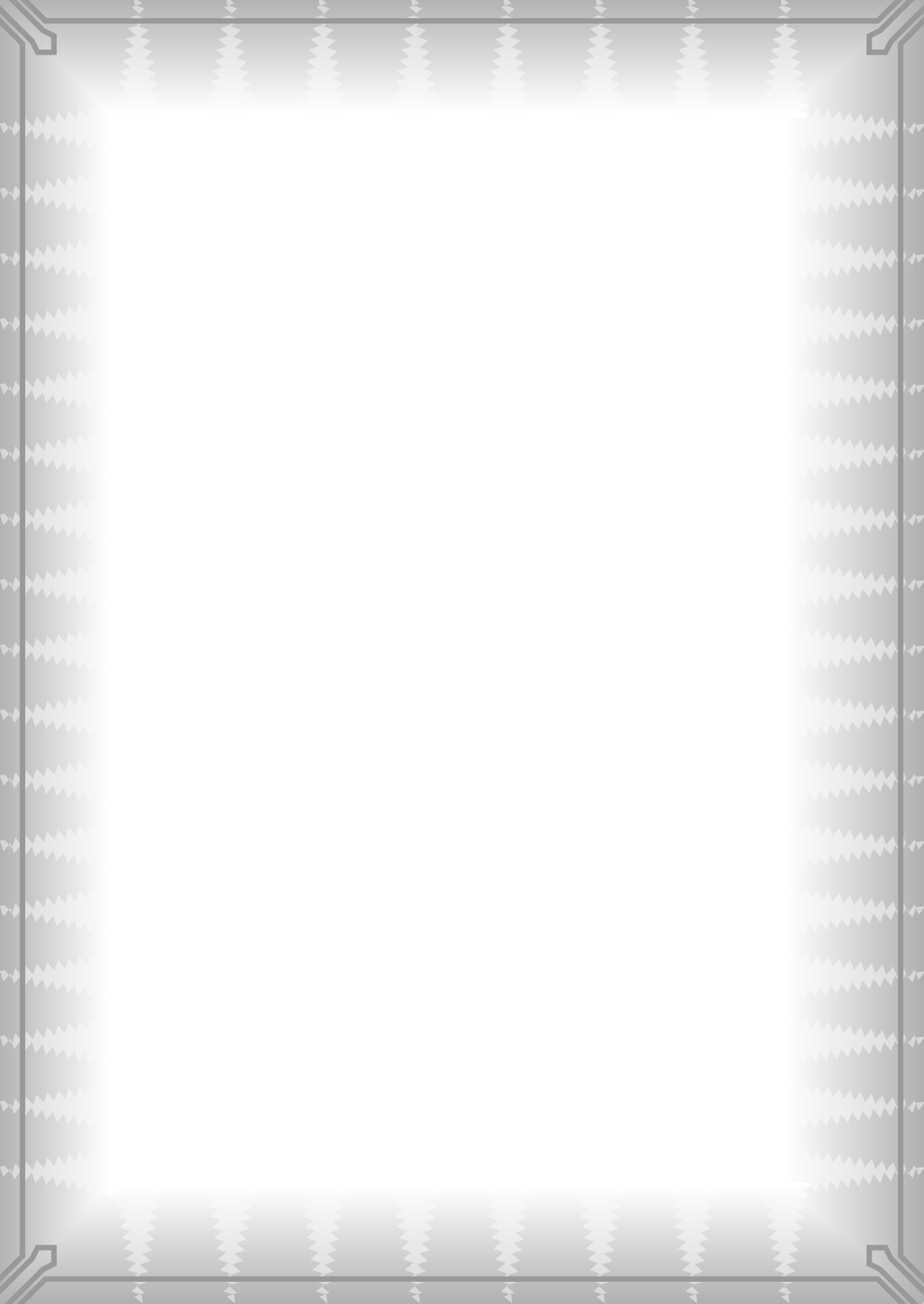
The Setting





Part III

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